

Islamic Civilization - Short Notes

1. Rise of Islam & Teachings

- Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) was born in 570 CE in Mecca.
- Received first revelation in 610 CE.
- Quran & Hadith are the fundamental sources of Islam.
- Five Pillars of Islam: Shahada (Faith), Salah (Prayer), Zakat (Charity), Sawm (Fasting), Hajj (Pilgrimage).
- Hijrah (622 CE) - Migration to Medina, Islam spread through Arabia.

2. Arab Empire under Umayyads (661-750 CE)

- Founded by Muawiya I in 661 CE.
- Capital: Damascus (Syria).
- Expanded from Spain to Central Asia.
- Arabic became the official language.
- Declined due to corruption and the Abbasid revolution in 750 CE.

3. Abbasid Caliphate (750-1258 CE)

- Capital: Baghdad, House of Wisdom (Bayt al-Hikma) established.
- Golden Age of Islam: Advancements in science, medicine, philosophy, and literature.
- Famous Scholars: Al-Khwarizmi (Algebra), Avicenna (Medicine), Al-Razi (Chemistry).
- Declined due to Mongol invasion in 1258 CE.

4. Muslim Spain (Al-Andalus)

- Flourished under Umayyads in Cordoba.
- Major cultural and scientific advancements.
- Famous Scholars: Ibn Rushd (Averroes), Al-Zahrawi (Surgery).
- Reconquista led to fall of Granada in 1492 CE.

5. Seljuks, Safavids, and Ottomans

- Seljuks (11th-13th Century): Controlled Anatolia, defeated Byzantines.
- Safavids (16th-18th Century): Shi'a Islam spread in Persia.
- Ottoman Empire (1299-1922): Largest Muslim empire, peak under Suleiman the Magnificent.